

THE RISING HAS BEGUN

The greater the number of women who build strength and break the chains of silence, the greater the respect and power of the feminine gender

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It amuses me when people think that women still belong to the Stone Age. I'm not surprised when women today openly debate over sexual boredom, guilt, and extra-marital affairs. I think women today are sexually liberated free spirits and are willing to acknowledge their libido. Today women no longer strictly adhere to parameters set by the past generation to decide what love means, what relationships are all about, and the power men should or shouldn't have in determining a woman's happiness. It's all about strident self-gratification. Women are no longer the suppressed beings that they were and they today have the power to express themselves freely.

The expression "woman of today" most definitely redefines the very social fabric of the Indian society. Portrayal of the same in my shows is, however, keeping in mind the very delicate nuances of the Indian society. However, I think society

has today adapted to the re-defined dynamics of sexual behaviour and women are allowed to take their stance more freely. The standards today are much higher than a decade ago. Earlier it was okay for a man in a position of power to abuse the privilege he held by humiliating and demeaning and embarrassing women but today women are standing up and speaking up for the female gender.

What has changed today is not our standards but that women are now willing to risk the further humiliation of having disturbing events from the past being ridiculed as not important.

What has changed is that women are made to believe that sexual harassment is taken seriously in a society, albeit a society that is still fumbling with how relations between men and women work. Women today will not stay quiet and be their quintessential selves, they now come out in the open and

speak their minds and not crumble from within. In today's world as women become fearless storytellers their voices will become widespread thus resulting in greater credibility and confidence in the face of silence. Breaking these bonds of silence is transformative for women because it allows them to remove facades that once covered their experiences and often gave them a new found sense of empowerment.

As women learn to use their voices to describe their feelings and experiences they are drawn closer to the realisation that they have the power to create their stories—and their stories no longer have the power to create them. Women today are no longer avoiding issues which are usually avoided in polite discussions. In fact, they want to discuss these issues in the front and in the open. This is essential for the betterment of the feminine gender, which has been kept buried within the walls of silence. How many women today suffer because of a plethora of reasons? The greater the number of women who will become symbols of expression, the greater the number of women who build strength and break the chains of silence, the greater the respect and power of the feminine gender.

I am confident there will be a transformation, in fact, "The Rising" has begun.

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FEMME FATALE: Star cast of Kapoor's *Kyunki...* serial

